

Superstore Dataset Analysis

The Problem This analysis examines four years of sales data from a US-based retail business spanning 2014 to 2017. With \$1.10M in total revenue and \$132.52K in total profit, the goal was to identify where the business is performing well, where it is underperforming, and where the strongest growth opportunities lie.

What the Data Says: Four patterns stand out from the analysis:

- The East region leads all regions with \$330,694 in sales, making it the single strongest market for the business
- Technology is the top performing category with \$380,640 in sales and \$70,157 in profit, the only category delivering strong returns on both fronts
- The Canon ImageClass 2200 Advanced Copier is the top selling product by revenue, indicating strong demand in office equipment
- Revenue dipped in 2015 before recovering in 2016 and settling into slow but steady growth through 2017

What's Actually Going On: The business has a clear strength in Technology and the East region, but the overall profit margin of roughly 12% against \$1.10M in revenue suggests that other categories are either underperforming or being sold at thin margins. The 2015 dip is worth investigating — whether it was driven by market conditions, inventory issues, or pricing decisions could inform how the business protects itself from similar dips going forward.

What the Business Should Do:

- Double down on Technology- it is the only category delivering strong sales and profit simultaneously and deserves prioritised investment
- Investigate what is dragging down overall profit margins- a 12% margin on \$1.10M suggests Furniture or Office Supplies may be selling at a loss or with heavy discounting
- Replicate the East region's performance in underperforming regions by identifying what is working there and applying it elsewhere
- Understand the 2015 revenue dip to prevent a repeat- was it seasonal, operational, or market-driven?